

Evidence before verdicts.

The process starts by fixing what is being assessed - before anyone sees a score.



01 Define the debate

Check for duplicates. Identify the recording, speakers, event year and one **neutral question**. Record what each side must establish: its burden. A critic need not prove an alternative unless that burden is adopted.

02 Secure the complete source

Check transcript coverage, material gaps and speaker changes against the **full debate**. Use complete captions; transcribe if needed. Preserve timestamps and digital fingerprints that reveal later changes to the evidence.

03 Map the arguments, then lock the evidence

Identify important claims, replies, concessions and unanswered objections. Tie each selected **move** to an exact source passage, speaker, topic and relevant burden or reply. Explain unequal coverage: never invent symmetry or drop arguments just to fit the display.

FIXED BEFORE JUDGMENT

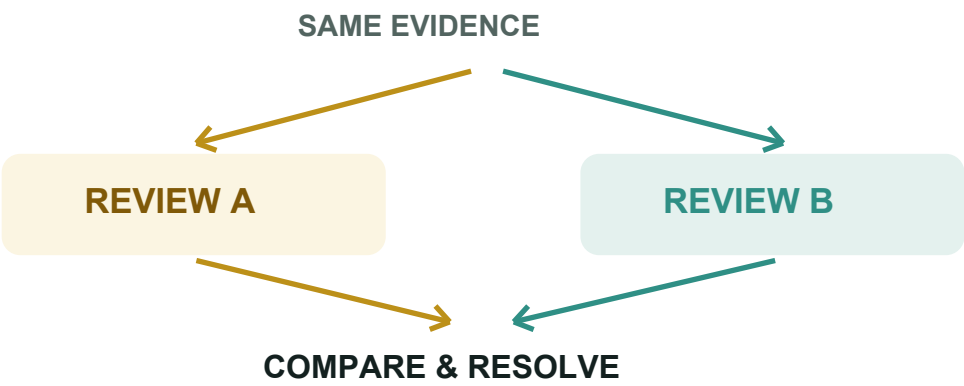
Section weights: total 100%.

Move importance: 1, 2 or 3.

Source, scope and assessment rules are frozen with the inventory.

04 Two isolated AI reviews

Both review the **same locked evidence** and rate every selected move, with reasons. Neither sees the other's judgments, previous scorecards, published commentary or winner labels.



05 Resolve differences

Check audio whenever speaker attribution is below high confidence. A **fresh adjudicator** reviews flagged differences using source evidence and anonymous options. Undisputed numerical ratings use rounded means. Freeze the resolved record.

REVIEW TRIGGERS

Dimension gap >8 points • Move-score gap >4

Adjustment gap >2 • Relevant categorical differences

CONTROLLED INPUTS. NOT PERFECT OBJECTIVITY.

Selection is curated, not a representative sample of all debates. Independent review here means **separate AI contexts** with controlled inputs, not unrelated model families. The separation reduces anchoring, but shared model biases and mistaken judgments can remain.

Judgments become scores.

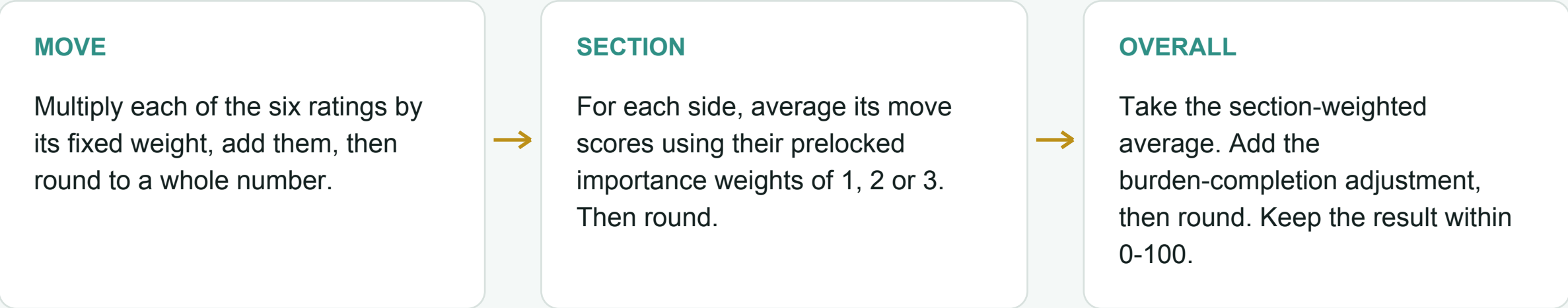
A score is earned move by move. Fixed rules turn the resolved ratings into section and overall scores.



06 Six dimensions, one move score

Every dimension is rated from 0 to 100.

25%	Logical coherence	Does the conclusion follow from its premises?
20%	Evidence and warrant	Is the support adequate and connected to the conclusion?
20%	Responsiveness	Does it answer the actual live challenge?
15%	Relevance and burden	Does it advance or challenge what must be established?
10%	Precision and clarity	Are terms, scope and qualifications clear?
10%	Calibration and charity	Is confidence justified, and the opposing argument represented fairly?



THE ONLY OVERALL ADJUSTMENT: -5 TO +5

An integer for consequential case completion not already counted in the moves. It cannot reward style or penalize the same defect twice. Section weights total 100% and cannot be tuned after judgment.

WORKED EXAMPLES

Illustrations only, not actual debate results.

SECTION

Move scores **80** and **70**; importance **2** and **1**.

$(80 \times 2 + 70 \times 1) \div 3 \approx 76.67$

Rounded section score

77

OVERALL

Section scores **80** and **70**; weights **60%** and **40%**; adjustment **+2**.

$48 + 28 + 2 =$

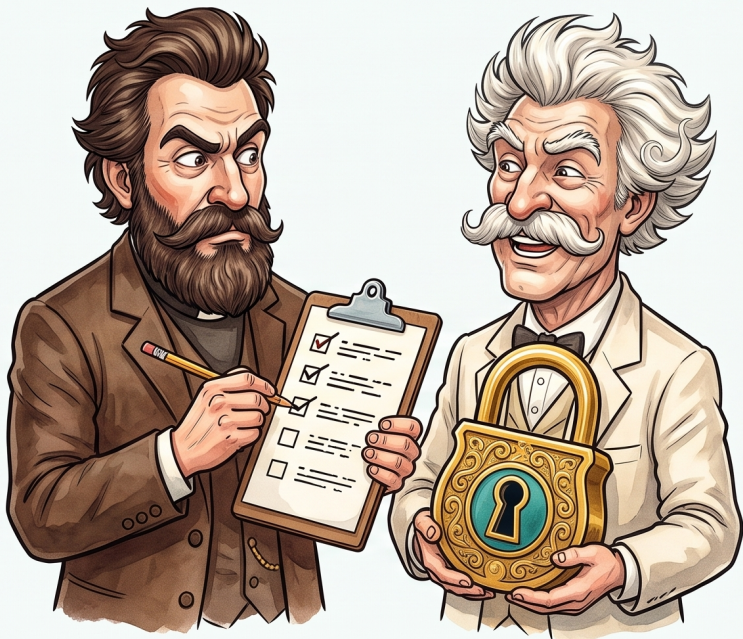
A separate example, not a continuation of the left one.

78

Calculate once. Then lock. Code derives the final totals; models do not author totals, and people do not hand-adjust them. Stability checks compare the result with both initial passes. Failed checks block acceptance rather than invite score tuning.

Explain. Challenge. Verify.

After the scores are locked, the work turns to clear explanations, careful labels and publication checks.

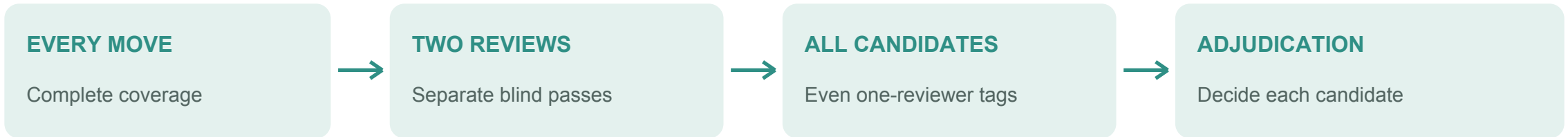


07 Explain the locked result

Publish every selected move exactly once, with accurate quotations and timestamps. Explain its **strongest feature**, **principal limitation**, **remaining burden** and **score**. Overall commentary identifies concrete strengths and material blunders for both sides. Explanations cannot change the locked scoring record.

08 Check fallacies and cognitive biases

Only after scores **and critiques** are locked, two fresh blind reviews examine every move using **LogFall** and **CogBias** definitions. Neither sees existing tags or the other review. A fresh adjudicator decides **every candidate** raised by either reviewer.



LABELS NEVER ADD A SCORE PENALTY

A tag must identify a source-supported defect **already reflected in the critique**. A contested premise is not automatically circular reasoning; citing an expert is not automatically an appeal-to-authority fallacy. Distinct labels require distinct failures. **Finding no applicable labels is valid.**

09 Separate the AI contribution

Clearly label strengthened arguments and genuinely new ideas for both sides. Check that they add specific reasoning rather than recycled filler. These are **not statements by the speakers** and never affect participant scores. Biography research also stays outside judgment packets.

10 Verify before publication

Check evidence fingerprints, calculations, quotations, tag decisions and complete move coverage. Compare explanation depth with **25 earlier debates**, without targeting their scores or tag rates. Test desktop, mobile and keyboard access. Preserve the audit record; unresolved failures block publication.

WHAT THE SCORE MEANS

An estimate of the reasoning presented, **not the truth of a worldview or a person's worth**. Fame, applause and speaking polish earn no automatic bonus.

STANDARD ROUTE: ONE ADVOCATE PER SIDE

Panels are not forced into this method. Authorized two-team assessments use a separately disclosed approach; moves retain their actual speaker. **Team scores do not enter individual one-on-one averages.**